

TRAVEL PREPARATION CHECKLIST

International travel requires thoughtful planning and careful organization to ensure a seamless experience from departure to return. Important considerations such as passport validity, visa requirements, health precautions, financial arrangements, and packing essentials must be addressed well in advance. A comprehensive travel preparation checklist provides a structured approach to managing these details, minimizing unexpected complications and reducing travel-related stress. By systematically reviewing each requirement before departure, travelers can enhance safety, efficiency, and overall enjoyment throughout the journey.

1 Travel Documents

- ☐ Passport valid for at least 6 months beyond return date
- ☐ Print and save digital copies of: passport, visa, flight tickets, hotel confirmation, travel insurance
- ☐ Apply for visa if required
- ☐ Check visa requirements for your destination (tourist, business, transit)
- ☐ Register trip with your country's embassy (if applicable)

2 Health and Medical

- ☐ Pack prescription medications (in original containers)
- ☐ Check required or recommended vaccines
- ☐ Purchase travel medical insurance
- ☐ Schedule travel clinic appointment (if needed)
- ☐ Bring copy of prescriptions
- ☐ Pack small first aid kit

3 Flight and Transportation

- ☐ Confirm flights 24–48 hours before departure
- ☐ Arrange airport transportation (ride, taxi, train, parking)
- ☐ Pre-book airport transfers (if needed)
- ☐ Download airline app
- ☐ Check baggage allowance and restrictions

4 Accommodation

- ☐ Confirm hotel or lodging reservations
- ☐ Save address in local language
- ☐ Note check-in requirements and times
- ☐ Research neighborhood safety and nearby transport

5 Money and Finances

- ☐ Notify bank and credit card companies
- ☐ Bring at least two payment methods
- ☐ Check ATM availability at destination
- ☐ Check foreign transaction fees
- ☐ Get small amount of local currency
- ☐ Set up mobile payment apps (if widely accepted)

6 Phone and Connectivity

- ☐ Check international roaming rates
- ☐ Unlock phone (if necessary)
- ☐ Install translation app (e.g., Google Translate)
- ☐ Consider international plan or eSIM
- ☐ Download offline maps (e.g., Google Maps)
- ☐ Save important contacts offline

7 Packing Essentials

7.1 Clothing

- ☐ Check weather forecast
- ☐ Comfortable walking shoes
- ☐ Sleepwear and undergarments
- ☐ Pack appropriate clothing
- ☐ Travel adapter and converter

7.2 Toiletries

- ☐ Travel-size liquids (under 100ml for carry-on)
- ☐ Deodorant
- ☐ Personal hygiene items
- ☐ Toothbrush and toothpaste
- ☐ Sunscreen

7.3 Travel Gear

- ☐ Neck pillow
- ☐ Reusable water bottle
- ☐ Luggage tags
- ☐ Eye mask and earplugs
- ☐ Portable charger / power bank

8 Security and Safety

- ☐ Check travel advisories
- ☐ Set emergency contacts
- ☐ Enable phone tracking
- ☐ Research local laws and customs
- ☐ Share itinerary with trusted contact
- ☐ Use anti-theft bag or money belt

9 Travel Day

9.1 Before Leaving

- ☐ Hold mail delivery
- ☐ Set thermostat appropriately
- ☐ Take out trash
- ☐ Arrange pet care
- ☐ Unplug appliances
- ☐ Lock all windows and doors

9.2 At the airport

- ☐ Arrive 3 hours early (international)
- ☐ Check duty-free restrictions
- ☐ Have passport and boarding pass ready
- ☐ Stay hydrated